



CRENT (working name)

Launch lean, keep 15%, *rethink* the name.

Deployment, commissions, client types, Philippine legal and tax, a full marketing plan with ready-to-post content, and the CRENT name check. Research compiled from six parallel investigations with ~140 cited sources.

Research report

For the founder and team

3 October 2026

Version 1.0

Status

Figures flagged "re-verify" need a live check

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Bottom line. The app now called Outlier Desk can go live on a compliant stack for about **\$50 a month (≈₱2,900)**: Vercel Pro (\$20, required because Vercel's free plan bans commercial apps), Supabase Pro in Singapore (\$25, because the free plan pauses after 7 idle days and has no backups), with email, monitoring and cron on free tiers and a Philippine payment gateway (Xendit or PayMongo) that charges only per transaction. Keep the current **5% creator fee + 10% researcher fee** (a blended ≈15% take, below Upwork's 18.7% and Fiverr's 27.7%), but force creators to fund budgets in **\$20 minimum top-ups** (or \$10 via GCash) so card fees do not eat 40–70% of CRENT's margin on \$3–\$8 ideas; break-even on a \$100–\$300 monthly cost base is roughly **\$950–\$2,900 of monthly GMV**. The buyers who already pay for research as a *named job* are short-form agencies, TikTok Shop/DTC brands, podcast clipping teams and faceless-channel operators (job posts pay Filipino researchers \$300–\$2,500 a month), while solo creators currently spend \$29–\$69 a month on tools and are the natural "\$50 top-up" customer. Legally, the launch hinges on three choices: register a **One Person Corporation** (no minimum capital) rather than a sole proprietorship because the platform touches other people's money; never hold creator funds in CRENT's own bank account (route them through a BSP-supervised provider, or CRENT risks being an unregistered "operator of payment systems"); and treat the Internet Transactions Act, fully enforceable since 20 June 2025, as the rulebook for researcher verification, disclosures and complaints. Two premises in the original brief were wrong and matter: **RA 12063 is the Enterprise-Based Education and Training Act, not a Freelance Workers Protection Act (which is still a pending bill)**, and **crent.com belongs to a Los Angeles fintech that holds a registered US word mark "CRENT" (Reg. 5,686,508) covering a payments website**, which makes the rename a HIGH-risk move for a product selling to US creators. Marketing should spend nothing for the first 60 days: recruit supply through 200K-member Filipino freelancer Facebook groups and free OnlineJobs.ph posts, recruit demand through Reddit, LinkedIn and micro-creator affiliates, and reserve a Product Hunt launch for when 100 researchers and 200 ideas are live. A caveat governs every number here: the researchers could not open most official pages through the network proxy and worked from search summaries, so each figure flagged "re-verify" must be checked on the linked page before you act on it.

Read this first: two corrections and one caveat

The earlier brief assumed a Freelance Workers Protection Act was already law as "RA 12063". It is not. Search results show **RA 12063 is the Enterprise-Based Education and Training (EBET) Framework Act**, whose implementing rules were issued on 28 February 2025 ([Supreme Court E-Library](#)). The freelance bill passed the House on third reading and reached Senate committee hearings in August 2024 ([PNA](#); [L&E Global](#)), and a fresh bill was reportedly filed in December 2025 ([Cosmo.ph](#)), which is consistent with it not being law. Similarly, **NPC Circular 2024-01 amends the NPC's rules of procedure; the data-privacy fines schedule is NPC Circular 2022-01** ([NPC Circular 2024-01](#)).

The second correction concerns the name. The earlier assumption that "CRENT" was a clean coined word does not survive contact with the registers: crent.com is the website of Crent Inc., a Los Angeles credit-building startup founded in 2015 ([Crunchbase](#)), and a **live-looking US registration for the word mark CRENT (Serial 86873602, Reg. 5,686,508,**

registered 26 February 2019) covers "providing a website featuring technology that enables users to make rent payments, pay bills, make payments, split payments with others, and build credit" ([Justia Trademarks](#)). Section 6 deals with this in full.

The caveat: the sandbox proxy blocked direct access to Vercel, Supabase, Xendit, PayMongo, dot.ph, every WHOIS and trademark register, DTI, BIR, BSP, NPC, IPOPHL and most law-firm sites. Every number below therefore comes from search-result summaries or 2026 third-party round-ups that cite the official page, and the official link is given so you can re-check. Peso figures use an **illustrative ₱58/USD** rate (one note used ₱57); use the BSP reference rate on the day.

1. Production costs about \$50 a month on Vercel Pro and Supabase Pro

The app is a Next.js 15 App Router project on Supabase with Xendit behind a payment-provider interface, and the cheapest *legitimate* way to host it is Vercel Pro. Vercel's Hobby plan is "non-commercial, personal" use only, and Vercel's own examples of violations include "having a billing integration on the site (Stripe, Lemon Squeezy, Paddle)" ([Justin McKelvey.com](#), [Is Vercel Free?](#); [Makerkit](#), [Vercel cost 2026](#)); a marketplace with escrow is a commercial app from day one. **Pro costs \$20 per seat per month, includes \$20 of usage credit and 1 TB of bandwidth**, and allows commercial use ([CompareEdge](#)). Pro also matters for scheduled jobs: Hobby allows only 2 cron jobs per project, at most once a day, with timing precise only to the hour ([SteadyCron](#)), which is useless for a 72-hour escrow auto-release or hourly payout batching. If \$20 is too much at launch, Cloudflare Workers permits commercial use on its free plan (100,000 requests a day) and costs \$5 a month paid, via the OpenNext adapter that supports Next.js 15's App Router, Server Actions and Middleware, but not `runtime = "edge"` exports, and the free plan's 3 MiB gzipped bundle cap can be blown by a heavy Sentry server SDK ([OpenNext Cloudflare docs](#); [Cloudflare Workers limits](#)). Railway Hobby (\$5 with \$5 credit) is the other cheap option ([Makerkit](#), [best Next.js hosting](#)). A Singapore VPS (DigitalOcean 2 vCPU/4 GB at \$24 a month) only pays off once Vercel overages pass \$30–40 a month and someone is willing to patch a server ([Better Stack](#), [DO vs Hetzner](#)).

Use **Supabase Pro (\$25 a month) in the Singapore region ap-southeast-1** from launch. The free plan pauses projects after 7 days of inactivity and has no backups ([UI Bakery](#), [Supabase pricing](#)); Pro includes a \$10 compute credit, daily backups with 7-day retention and 250 GB of egress ([JetAdmin Supabase review](#)), and pricing is the same in every region ([getdeploying.com](#)). Point-in-time recovery is a **\$100 a month add-on** that can wait until GMV justifies it ([Backup Drill](#)). Turn on the spend cap. For researcher ID photos, make the bucket private, name objects with UUIDs, serve them only through short-lived signed URLs behind an ownership check, add row-level-security policies limiting reads to owner and admin, and keep the service-role key server-side ([Dev.to](#), [signed URLs will not save you](#)). The data-privacy section below adds a stronger rule: store as little of the ID as you can.

Email, monitoring and cron cost nothing at launch. **Resend's free plan gives 3,000 emails a month with a hard cap of 100 a day**; the daily cap, not the monthly one, is what pushes people to the \$20 Pro plan ([Coldletter](#), [Resend pricing](#); [Automation Atlas](#)). A marketplace sends roughly 5–10 emails per active user per month, so 100 users is ~1,000 emails (free) and 1,000 users is 5,000–10,000 with 200–350 a day at peaks, when Brevo (300 a day free, \$9 for 5,000) or Amazon SES (\$0.10 per 1,000) become the cheaper paid steps ([Brevo](#); [Bluey Email](#)). Send from a subdomain such as `mail.crent.ph`, publish the SPF, MX and DKIM records Resend generates, and start DMARC at `p=none` before tightening to `quarantine` ([Resend docs](#), [add a domain](#); [Resend docs](#), [DMARC](#)). For monitoring, Sentry's free tier (1 user, 5,000 errors a month) or PostHog's (1M events, 100k exceptions) covers errors and product analytics, and **Better Stack's free 10 monitors and heartbeats** should be pointed at the homepage, a `/api/health` route that checks the database, and the escrow-release cron, which is the single most valuable alert in a money-moving app ([AgentDeals PostHog](#); [Freetier.co Better Stack](#)). If you are not on Vercel Pro, run jobs from cron-job.org (free, down to one-minute intervals, custom headers for a secret token) rather than GitHub Actions `schedule`, which commonly fires 5–30 minutes late and is sometimes dropped on inactive repos ([Merginit cron comparison](#); [GitHub Community #201738](#)). Either way, build `/api/cron/<job>` routes that check an `Authorization: Bearer <CRON_SECRET>` header, keep each job

idempotent and under Vercel's 300-second function limit ([Vercel changelog](#)), and have each ping a Better Stack heartbeat.

Payments are the one part of the stack where the Philippines constrains you. Stripe is not on Stripe's supported-country list, and 2026 guides describe Philippine Stripe accounts as an invite-only preview with PHP-only payouts and many applicants waitlisted indefinitely ([Rapyd country list](#); [Hynogo](#)); treat it as unavailable. The realistic stack is a Philippine gateway for both money-in and money-out. **Xendit** quotes local cards at 3.20% + ₱10, internationally issued cards at 4.20% + ₱10, GCash 2.30%, Maya 1.80% ([Xendit PH pricing, summary](#)), though a second set of sources quotes GCash at 3.00% + ₱11 and disbursements at 1% (min ₱15) + ₱11 ([PhotonPay](#); [HitPay](#)), while Xendit's help centre says disbursements cost a flat ₱10 ([Xendit help, disbursement fee](#)); **get the current tariff in writing from Xendit sales before integrating**, because at 1,000 payouts a month the two readings differ by ₱10,000–₱31,000. Xendit accepts USD card payments for Philippine merchants ([Xendit help, accept USD](#)), charges a USD 25 chargeback fee, retains the original fees on refunds, and settles cards at T+5 business days ([Xendit Pricing Policy](#)). Its marketplace product xenPlatform costs **₱85 per active sub-account per month** ([Xendit help, XenPlatform fee](#)); if every verified researcher is a sub-account, 100 researchers is ₱8,500 a month, so ask whether "active" means "transacted this month" and design onboarding accordingly. **PayMongo** charges no monthly fee, Visa/Mastercard 3.125% + ₱13.39, international cards 4.02% + ₱13.39, GCash 2.23%, Maya 1.79%, QR Ph 1.3% ([PayMongo pricing](#); [Software-listing review](#)), and its docs describe batch disbursements from the PayMongo Wallet to banks and e-wallets as free, with bank payouts needing at least ₱80 cleared ([PayMongo docs, Disbursements](#)). On a \$100 international card payment the two gateways cost roughly ₱243–₱249, against ~₱437 via PayPal (4.4% + ₱15 plus ~3% FX) and ~₱456 via Lemon Squeezy, so the PH gateways are about half the price of the alternatives ([EcomCalcTools PayPal PH](#); [GetStackSmart L S fees](#)). Both gateways require a DTI or SEC registration plus BIR Form 2303, government IDs and a live website or social page, with the legal name matching the registration exactly ([Xendit help, PH legal documents](#)), which is why business registration must come before the payment integration.

MONTHLY COST	LAUNCH, 0–100 USERS	~1,000 USERS	WHY IT MOVES
Vercel Pro	\$20	\$20–40	Usage past the \$20 credit
Supabase Pro (Singapore)	\$25	\$25–40	Small compute add-on (\$15) if DB load grows; PITR +\$100 optional
Email	\$0 (Resend free)	\$1–20	>100 emails/day
Monitoring, cron	\$0	\$0–26	Sentry Team only if a second seat is needed
Domain (.ph \$48/yr + .com \$11/yr)	~\$5	~\$5	amortised
Fixed total	≈\$50 (≈₱2,900)	≈\$70–110 (≈₱4,000–6,300)	
Gateway fees (variable)	~4–4.5% of international-card GMV + ₱10–31 per payout	same	At ₱1M GMV: ₱42–45K card fees + ₱10–31K payouts (Xendit) or ~₱0 payouts (PayMongo batch)

The frugal variant (Cloudflare Workers free or \$5 + Supabase Pro) runs \$25–30 a month at the cost of OpenNext setup and bundle discipline. Domains add ~\$60 a year: .ph is **US\$48 a year at the dotPH registry** and .com about \$11 at Porkbun ([dotPH FAQs](#); [Priceworld Porkbun](#)). Before you call it launched, run one real PHP card payment, one USD card payment, one GCash payout, one Maya payout, one bank payout, one refund, a forced cron run, and a backup restore into a scratch project.

2. Keep the 5% + 10% take, but make creators fund \$20 budgets

CRENT's blended take sits at the low end of the market, and that is the right place for a platform that must first win supply. **Fiverr charges sellers a flat 20% and buyers 5.5% plus \$3.50 on orders under \$200**, and reported a 27.7%

marketplace take rate for FY2025 ([Fiverr Help](#); [Fiverr FY2025 20-F](#)). **Upwork** moved freelancers to a variable 0–15% fee in May 2025, charges clients 5% (10% on Business Plus) plus a \$0.99–\$14.99 contract-initiation fee, and reported an 18.7% take rate ([Upwork client pricing](#); [Upwork FY2025 results](#)). Creator-side marketplaces run hotter: Collabstr charges brands 10% and creators 15% with funds held until the brand approves ([Collabstr pricing](#)); Cameo takes 25% ([Influencer Marketing Hub](#)). The Tidemark framework says platforms that merely host charge 5–15% while marketplaces that bring demand charge 10–50%, with defensibility driven by new demand, seller convenience and competition ([Tidemark](#)). CRENT brings demand to Filipino researchers who otherwise sell \$5 idea bundles on Fiverr, so a **15–19% blended take is defensible**; drift upward later through a 7% card-funded creator fee and paid boosts rather than by raising the researcher fee.

The real margin problem is ticket size, not take rate. Per \$8 idea the creator pays \$8.40, the researcher receives \$7.20 and CRENT keeps \$1.20. If that \$8.40 were charged to a card on its own, PayMongo's 3.125% + ₱13.39 consumes about \$0.49, or **41% of CRENT's fee; on a \$3 idea it is 73%** (own arithmetic from the gateway rates above). Every incumbent protects small tickets with a surcharge or minimum (Fiverr's \$3.50, Freelancer.com's \$5 minimum that turns a \$20 project into a 25% fee, Etsy's \$0.20 + \$0.25) ([Freelancer.com fees](#); [Craftybase Etsy fees](#)). CRENT's structural answer is prepaid budgets: a creator who funds \$50 once by card pays about \$1.79 in processing (3.6%), or \$1.12 by GCash, and spread over six unlocks that is \$0.19–\$0.30 per idea. Net contribution then lands near **10–10.5% of GMV** after processing and payouts, so covering \$100–\$300 of fixed monthly cost needs **≈\$950–\$2,900 GMV a month, or 120–360 ideas at \$8, or 20–60 creators spending \$50 each**. The natural anchor for that \$50 is what creators already spend on research tools: 1of10 at \$29–\$69, Sandcastles \$39–\$79, vidIQ \$39, Spotter Studio \$49 ([1of10 review](#); [Coldiq Sandcastles](#); [OutlierKit vidIQ pricing](#)). "One Sandcastles month buys five ideas a human already verified" is the comparison to sell.

Payout mechanics should copy the market's shape but shorten its timelines. Upwork fixed-price work gives clients 14 days to approve, auto-releases on silence, then adds a 5-day security hold ([Upwork Help](#)); Fiverr clears funds after 14 days, 7 for top sellers ([Vaultleap](#)). An idea unlock is instant and verifiable, so the build spec's **72-hour dispute window plus a 7-day clearance (3 days for verified-pro researchers)** is both safer than nothing and visibly faster than Fiverr. Payout cost is the reason for a minimum withdrawal: Upwork charges \$0.99 to a Philippine bank and Fiverr \$1–\$3 via Payoneer, while Payoneer-to-GCash is free on the GCash side and Wise caps e-wallet payouts at ₱50,000 per transfer ([PinoyRemote](#), [Upwork withdrawals](#); [Manila Shaker](#), [GCash–Payoneer](#); [PinoyRemote](#), [Wise to GCash](#)). A **\$20 (≈₱1,160) minimum, or one free monthly batch payout**, keeps payout cost under ~2% of researcher earnings. Tier the researcher fee by proven performance the way 99designs (15% → 10% → 5% by level) and Freelancer.com (10% → 3% for preferred freelancers) do ([99designs Help](#)), and frame the differentiator as "10% with PHP payouts to GCash in days", because on an \$8 ticket "10% vs 20%" is \$0.80 and will not move anyone on its own.

Referral economics differ by side. Demand-side affiliates in this industry get either a bounty per first buyer (Fiverr pays \$15–\$150 CPA, or \$10 plus 10% revenue share for 12 months, with a \$100 minimum payout) or a SaaS-style 20–30% recurring commission for a year ([Fiverr Affiliates](#); [Tapiliate commission benchmarks](#)). Pay creator referrals as a share of **CRENT's fee**, never of GMV, so the program is margin-positive by construction. Supply-side recruiting in the Philippines runs on milestone bounties, not percentages: Payoneer pays \$250 to both parties after \$30,000 of volume, OnlineJobs.ph's Payoneer co-marketing pays \$75 after the first \$1,000 ([Payoneer RAF](#); [OnlineJobs.ph blog](#)), and GCash's GJobs pays referrers only when the referred person is hired ([GCash Help](#), [GJobs](#)). Double-sided rewards complete at 52% versus 29% for single-sided ([mean.ceo referral statistics](#)), so give both the referrer and the new creator something.

Recommended fee table

ITEM	RECOMMENDATION	BENCHMARK
Creator (buyer) fee	5% on each budget top-up ; consider 7% for card, 5% for GCash/QR Ph/bank	Upwork 5% (3% with bank), Fiverr 5.5%, Collabstr 10%
Researcher (seller) fee	10% standard → 7% "Verified" (≥100 unlocks, ≥4.5★) → 5% "Pro"	99designs 15 → 5%, Freelancer 10 → 3%, Fiverr flat 20%

ITEM	RECOMMENDATION	BENCHMARK
Bring-your-own-creator	0% creator fee and 5% researcher fee on invited creators for 12 months	Upwork Direct Contracts 5%; 99designs waives intro fee
Per-idea price band	\$3–\$500 allowed; guide to \$5–\$15; defaults \$5 / \$8 / \$12 / \$25 (short / standard / premium / series)	Fiverr \$5 for 10–25 unverified ideas; agency CRE cost ≈\$5–\$10 per vetted idea
Minimum budget top-up	\$20 by card (≈₱1,160); \$10 by GCash/Maya/QR Ph ; +3% bonus credit at \$100	PH card fixed fee ₱13.39; GCash has no fixed fee
Small-ticket surcharge	None when funded from a budget; ₱15 (≈\$0.26) only on one-off card unlocks	Fiverr \$3.50; Etsy \$0.20 + \$0.25
Dispute window	72 hours to flag "not as described", then auto-release	Upwork 14 days is for bespoke work
Clearance	7 days standard, 3 days Verified/Pro	Fiverr 14/7 days, Upwork 5-day hold
Minimum withdrawal	\$20 (≈₱1,160) or free monthly batch	Fixed payout costs \$1–\$3
Payout rails	GCash/Maya/InstaPay via the gateway; Wise/Payoneer for large balances	Upwork local bank \$0.99
Researcher Pro subscription	₱499/month: 5% fee, 3-day clearance, 3 boosted ideas, analytics	Fiverr Seller Plus \$25/\$49 is too steep for PHP incomes
Creator Plus (later)	\$19/month: 0% creator fee, saved-search alerts, priority briefs	Collabstr Premium cuts fee 10 → 5%
Boosted idea	\$1 flat for 7 days, not CPC	Fiverr Promoted Gigs CPC \$0.10–\$2.00; CRENT lacks auction volume
Creator referral	25% of CRENT's fee on the referred creator's spend for 12 months, or \$5 flat per first-funded creator; both sides get 1 free unlock	Fiverr hybrid \$10 + 10%; SaaS 20–30% recurring
Researcher ambassador	₱300 when the referred researcher's 10th idea is unlocked, ₱700 at the 50th; monthly leaderboard bonus	Payoneer/OnlineJobs milestone bounties
Target blended take	≈15% now, drifting to 17–19% via card fee, boosts and subscriptions	Stay under Upwork's 18.7%

Keep the per-idea floor at \$3 for cheap, simple ideas, but never let a \$3 idea be the first card charge a creator makes.

3. Ten client types pay for research; four already pay for it by name

The addressable buyer is not "all creators". Kit's data says 46.7% of creators are full-time and 59% of those reported burnout in the past year ([The Creator Economy, State 2026](#)), Linktree found 70% earned under \$49,000 ([Linktree blog](#)), and Kajabi reports entrepreneurial creators (courses, coaching) earn 25% more than social-first ones while platform payouts and brand deals fell sharply ([BusinessWire, Kajabi 2025](#)). The paying set is the full-time minority plus the businesses that produce content at volume. The four segments that already post job ads with "content researcher" in the title are the ones to sell to first: short-form agencies serving coaches, TikTok Shop and DTC brands, podcast clipping teams and faceless-channel operators. OnlineJobs.ph listings in 2025–2026 show exactly what they pay Filipino researchers: **"Content Researcher — Find Viral TikTok & Instagram Content" at \$300–\$800 a month for 25 hours a week**, **"TikTok Content Researcher & Brief Writer"** at \$3–\$5 an hour, and **"TikTok Shop Creative Strategist & Viral Content Researcher" at \$1,500–\$2,500 a month** with research tools and a US VPN supplied ([OnlineJobs.ph 1589965](#); [OnlineJobs.ph 1605016](#); [OnlineJobs.ph 1705564](#)). Young Publisher, the short-form agency behind the Content

Research Expert role, advertises full-time CREs at **\$800 a month base with bonuses to \$1,000–\$1,100** ([OnlineJobs.ph CRE listing](#)). Those posts are the market telling you that a verified idea is worth \$5–\$10 of labour.

CLIENT TYPE	WHAT THEY PAY TODAY	WHERE TO FIND THEM	BEST CRENT OFFER
Short-form agencies serving coaches/personal brands (Young Publisher model)	\$300–\$2,500/month per researcher seat; agency retainers \$4K–\$8K/month include "strategy and trend research" (Green Frog Labs)	Facebook SMM groups (25K–50K members), OnlineJobs.ph employer side, LinkedIn founder posts (HeyOrca)	5-idea batches per client at \$50–\$100; white-label weekly retainer \$400–\$800/month
TikTok Shop / DTC brands	Strategist-researchers at \$1,500–\$2,500/month; UGC averages \$198 per deliverable; playbooks call for 200–300 videos/month (Influencee ; Top Growth Marketing)	TikTok Shop seller communities, UGC marketplaces	"100-video outlier swipe file per product category" \$150–\$300
Podcast clipping teams	Retainers \$1,250–\$25,000/month; "needle-moving" clips \$150–\$300 each (Forkoff , page blocked , search extract)	Clipping-agency comparison pages (Overlap)	"Find the 3–5 moments before your editor cuts" per-episode brief
Faceless / YouTube automation operators	\$25–\$80 per lean video, \$80–\$200 with pro editor (PostLabs)	r/NewTubers, niche-research tool blogs	\$5–\$20 of research per video; niche trend report \$50–\$150
Full-time short-form creators	Tools: 1of10 \$29–\$69, OutlierKit \$29–\$199, vidIQ \$39; Fiverr \$5 idea bundles	r/NewTubers (579K–723K members, +27%/yr), Publish Press (160K readers), Paddy Galloway's ~500K following (Hive Index ; Tubefilter)	\$50 budget = 5–8 verified ideas; single idea + brief \$10–\$25
Long-form YouTubers	Upwork outlier-research strategists at \$75/hr; in-house YouTube strategists ~\$135K/yr (Upwork profile ; Glassdoor)	Same as above, plus Colin & Samir and Jon Youshaei comment sections	Title/thumbnail packaging research \$25–\$60 per video (vs VidChops \$225/month for 4)
Coaches / course sellers	Funnel-content budgets \$3K–\$15K/month via agencies (Laxia)	Skool communities (180K–440K members) (RevenueGeeks)	Beginner-proof briefs: "no studio, no editor"
Personal brands (founders, doctors, lawyers, realtors)	Agencies \$3.5K–\$25K/month; Filipino VAs already write their LinkedIn at ~\$7/hr (Clash.cc ; Rest of World)	LinkedIn	Monthly 20-outlier report \$50–\$150
Local businesses	~40% spent under \$5K on all video last year (Wix)	Local FB groups	Low priority: smallest budgets, least "outlier" literacy
OnlyFans / creator managers	Filipino chatters \$3.50–\$7/hr; 30–40% of big earners agency-managed (OFM Tools ; Sirency)	Agency directories	Brand-safety judgment call; not recommended for launch

The productized menu follows from the anchors. Prices below are **estimates triangulated from the cited ranges, not observed CRENT prices**: a single verified idea with a full brief at \$10–\$25 (creators) or \$15–\$40 (agencies); a 5-idea batch, the Young Publisher unit of delivery, at \$50–\$100; a 10-idea pack at \$90–\$180 with the ~19% bundle discount UGC marketplaces use ([Influencee](#)); a weekly retainer of 5 briefs plus tracking sheet at \$200–\$400 a month to solo creators and \$400–\$800 to agencies (undercutting a \$1,240-a-month full-time hire while paying the researcher above \$5 an hour if a batch takes 4–6 hours); hook rewrites at \$5–\$15 each; a competitor channel audit at \$75–\$200; thumbnail and title research at \$25–\$60 per video; a monthly niche trend report at \$50–\$150, white-labelled \$150–\$300. What makes a researcher "verified" can be lifted almost whole from the agency standard: a hard filter (source account under 100k followers, 500k+ views, posted within a year, viral in the US or Europe, realistically recreatable), five instant-reject flags, raw numbers rather than "25x" multiples, and a fixed brief template running thought process → format → three-part hook

→ edit steps with seconds → audio steps → notes → a CTA containing "Follow" → caption. Publishing that filter is also the answer to the three objections buyers raise. On "this is idea theft", the ethical line is to copy formats rather than content and to credit the format ([Hook Studio](#); [Paddy Galloway on X](#)), and once a concept has been replicated enough to be a trend it is widely regarded as fair game while exact wording and assets remain protected ([JIPLP](#)). On "I have vidIQ", vidIQ itself says it tells you what people search for and "does not systematically surface videos performing 10x above average", and 1of10 is YouTube-only ([vidIQ vs 1of10](#)). On quality, the proof is a tracking-sheet row and screenshot per idea, which is the audit trail agencies already expect.

4. Legal: an OPC, a payment partner that holds the money, and the ITA

Entity. A DTI sole proprietorship with national scope costs ₱2,030 (₱2,000 plus ₱30 documentary stamp tax) and is valid for five years ([Pinoy Negosyo](#); [Orkids](#)), but it leaves the founder personally liable for every creator refund and researcher payout. An SEC **One Person Corporation has no general statutory minimum capital**, a basic filing fee of 0.2% of capital but not less than ₱2,000, plus ₱100 name verification, ₱510 by-laws and ₱360 stock-and-transfer book, with MSME discounts of 20–50% ([InCorp OPC guide](#); [Respicio, OPC fees](#); [Wise, SEC registration](#)), and it can be filed through SEC eSPARC/OneSEC in minutes ([Forvis Mazars](#)). The trade-off is tax: only self-employed individuals can elect the **8% flat tax on gross receipts above ₱250,000 in lieu of income tax and the 3% percentage tax**, available below ₱3M of receipts ([Grant Thornton, the 8% tax](#)); an OPC pays corporate income tax (rate not researched here; re-verify). For a platform that touches other people's money the liability shield wins; confirm with a CPA. Either way, Naga City requires a Barangay Business Clearance, cedula, zoning, sanitary, fire and occupancy clearances and a Mayor's Permit from the Business One-Stop Shop at the People's Hall before operations ([Naga City requirements PDF](#)); the fee schedule could not be fetched. BIR registration uses Form 1901 (sole prop) or 1903 (OPC); the ₱500 annual registration fee was abolished by the Ease of Paying Taxes Act in January 2024, leaving ₱30 DST for books ([LiveInPH 2026 guide](#)); invoices (not official receipts) are now the primary document for services under RR 7-2024 ([Grant Thornton, RR 7-2024](#)). Mandatory e-invoicing for businesses "engaged in e-commerce or internet transactions" under RR 11-2025 was **extended by RR 26-2025 to 31 December 2026**, with micro taxpayers exempt ([Philstar, Nov 2025](#); [PwC](#)). BMBE registration is free, covers service businesses with assets of ₱3M or less and exempts income from operations from income tax ([DTI BMBE FAQ](#)), but whether an online platform qualifies was not confirmed.

Money. This is the most important design constraint in the whole report. Under the National Payment Systems Act and BSP Circular 1049, "payment gateways, platform providers, payment facilitators and merchant acquirers that enable sellers of goods and services to accept payments" are **Operators of Payment Systems that must register with the BSP** ([PIA, BSP reminder](#); [BSP OPS FAQ](#)), and issuing stored value needs an e-money issuer licence ([NDV Law on EMI s](#)). If CRENT collects creator budgets into its own bank account and pays researchers from it, it is arguably a payment facilitator and possibly an EMI. The structure the sources support is that creators pay through a BSP-supervised gateway, the funds sit in that provider's platform sub-ledger (Xendit Philippines "is supervised and regulated by the Bangko Sentral ng Pilipinas" and xenPlatform exists to onboard sellers, split and route payments ([Xendit marketplace solutions](#))), and on unlock the provider splits CRENT's fee to CRENT and disburses the rest to the researcher's GCash, Maya or bank. In that model CRENT is a merchant client of a registered operator, not an operator itself. No source explicitly confirmed that a marketplace holding funds in its own account is outside OPS registration, so this is the first question for a lawyer, and until it is answered **do not use the word "escrow" in marketing or terms**; say "funds held by our payment partner until you approve". The same structure keeps CRENT outside the Anti-Money Laundering Act's "covered persons" (banks, EMIs, payment system operators, remittance agents) ([Verihubs](#)); CRENT's practical duty is to verify each researcher's ID and TIN, require the payout wallet to be in the researcher's own name, and keep records.

The Internet Transactions Act (RA 11967). Its 18-month transition ended on 20 June 2025 and it is fully enforceable ([Manila Times](#)). It applies when one party is in the Philippines ([Lexology primer](#)), so CRENT is an e-marketplace and the researchers are its "online merchants". It must verify them with ordinary diligence, collect business name, contact details, proof of identity and **their BIR Certificate of Registration**, keep a merchant list, disclose price, description and seller contact details, run an internal complaints and redress mechanism, remove illegal content within 48 hours of

notice, and register in the DTI E-Commerce Bureau's Online Business Database ([Cruz Marcelo](#); [Lexology, Regulating E-Commerce](#)). Administrative fines are reported at up to ₱1 million (₱20,000–₱100,000 first offence, ₱100,000–₱500,000 second) ([Lexology](#)), though one source says up to ₱5 million and that the ITA "mandates marketplace escrow" ([lawyer-philippines.com](#)); both points need a lawyer's reading of the statute. Whether the Online Business Database is accepting registrations in October 2026 could not be confirmed.

Data privacy (RA 10173). Every personal-information controller must designate a Data Protection Officer; registering the data-processing system with the NPC becomes mandatory at 250 employees, or when processing **sensitive personal information of 1,000 or more individuals**, or whenever processing involves automated decision-making or profiling ([NPC Circular 2022-04](#); [InCorp advisory](#)), with 20 days to register once triggered ([Global Compliance News](#)). Government-ID images are sensitive personal information (from general knowledge of the statute; unverified), and the researcher levels and ranking already built are arguably profiling, so plan to register early. Breaches must be reported to the NPC **within 72 hours** ([NPC breach reporting](#)); fines under NPC Circular 2022-01 run 0.25–3% of annual gross income, capped at ₱5 million ([Lexology](#)). The practical design is to verify IDs through the payment or KYC provider and keep only a verification result plus minimal metadata, rather than storing ID photos indefinitely.

Tax on the flows. Below ₱3M of gross receipts CRENT is non-VAT and pays 3% percentage tax quarterly on Form 2551Q, or an individual elects the 8% option ([CloudCFO](#)). Once VAT-registered, fees charged in USD to foreign businesses outside the Philippines are a strong zero-rating candidate under NIRC 108(B)(2) ([Tax and Accounting Center](#)), and RR 3-2025 implementing the digital-services VAT law (RA 12023) treats digital services as VATable only when the buyer is in the Philippines ([MTF Counsel](#)), so the 10% fee charged to Philippine researchers would be 12% VAT and the 5% fee to US creators 0%. The genuinely unsettled question is withholding on researcher payouts: **RR 16-2023 makes e-marketplace operators withhold 1% of half of gross remittances to sellers, but only once a seller passes ₱500,000 a year**, with RMC 8-2024 putting the duty on "the last facility in control of payment" ([Cruz Marcelo on RR 16-2023](#); [PwC Tax Alert 5-2024](#)), whereas if CRENT is the "payor of professional fees" it must withhold 5% (10% without a sworn declaration) on every payout and file 0619-E, 1601-EQ, 1604-E and issue 2307s ([Grant Thornton on 5% EWT](#); [M PM.ph 1601-EQ](#)). The pure-marketplace structure (provider holds funds, CRENT only earns fees) points to the first reading; ask the gateway how it handles RR 16-2023 for platform clients.

Contracts and IP. Blanket "no refunds" terms are a deceptive sales act under the Consumer Act with fines reported up to ₱300,000 ([TermsBox](#)), so the terms must refund creators in full when no pitch is accepted or a researcher fails to deliver, offer a revision or partial refund for non-conforming briefs, and only exclude change-of-mind refunds after approval. Non-circumvention clauses are enforceable under Civil Code Art. 1306 only if reasonable in time, trade and place ([Respicio, non-compete law](#)); limit the clause to 12 months and to the specific researcher–creator pair introduced on the platform. Because IP Code Sec. 175 denies copyright to "any idea, procedure, system, method ... even if expressed" ([NDV Law](#)), the locked card is protected by contract and by the technical rule that locked fields never reach the browser, not by copyright; the terms should treat unpurchased pitches as the researcher's confidential information and licence the written brief to the creator on payment. The pending freelance bill would require a plain-language written contract before work starts (services, rate, payment schedule, period, breach grounds, TIN), 30% upfront and payment within 15 days ([House Bill 9768 text](#); [L&E Global](#)); auto-generating that contract per accepted pitch costs nothing now and pre-empts the law. Keep researchers free to choose briefs, set their own prices and work by their own methods, because a platform that assigns work and supervises methods invites an employer-misclassification claim. For the brand, an IPOPHL small-entity filing costs about **₱1,200 per class plus ~₱900 publication and ~₱570 issuance**, so roughly ₱4,000–₱5,000 for Classes 35 and 42, with Declarations of Actual Use due in years 3 and 5 ([IPOPHL fee schedule via Scribd](#); re-verify on [ipophil.gov.ph](#)).

Before launch

1. Pick the entity (OPC via eSPARC recommended; ₱3,000–₱5,000 in SEC fees at a modest authorised capital) and register the DTI/SEC name in the exact form the gateway will see.
2. Naga City: barangay clearance → Business One-Stop Shop → Mayor's Permit (fees per local revenue code, unverified).

3. BIR: Form 1901 or 1903, Certificate of Registration (2303), books (P30 DST), invoice setup under RR 7-2024, choose 3% percentage tax vs 8% (individuals only), register as a withholding agent.
4. Sign with a BSP-supervised gateway (Xendit xenPlatform or PayMongo) so that creator funds are held and split by the provider, never in CRENT's account; get written answers on USD acceptance, holding funds until unlock, partial card refunds, GCash/Maya/bank payouts, the P85 sub-account fee definition, and RR 16-2023 handling.
5. ITA: researcher KYC (ID, address, contact, BIR COR), merchant list, platform disclosures, visible complaints channel, 48-hour takedown workflow, record keeping; register in the Online Business Database once it is open.
6. Data privacy: privacy notice, consent flows, DPO designation (the founder, initially), 72-hour breach plan, data-processing agreements with the gateway and cloud host, minimal ID retention; NPC registration now if ranking counts as profiling.
7. Terms of service: intermediary status, fund-hold mechanics, lawful refund policy, 72-hour dispute process, 12-month non-circumvention, confidentiality and licence-on-payment terms, auto-generated per-engagement contract.
8. IPOPHL search, then file the chosen brand in Classes 35 and 42 (and consider 41).

Later

NPC data-processing-system registration at 1,000 researchers (20-day deadline); trademark DAUs in years 3 and 5; DTI name renewal every 5 years; SEC GIS and audited financial statements annually for an OPC; VAT registration at P3M with 108(B)(2) zero-rating documentation; RR 16-2023 withholding once any researcher passes P500,000 a year; mandatory e-invoicing by 31 December 2026 unless classed as micro; BMBE application if eligible.

Questions for a lawyer or CPA

Is CRENT an operator of payment systems under RA 11127 and Circular 1049 even when a licensed provider holds the funds, and does any ITA rule impose "escrow" duties? Which withholding regime applies to payouts (RR 16-2023 at 1% of half above P500k, 5%/10% professional-fee EWT, or the provider as "last facility in control"), and are pass-through budgets excluded from CRENT's gross receipts for the P3M and 8% tests? What documentation proves zero-rating for foreign creators, and how is the 10% researcher fee treated? Does the gateway require a corporation? What is the lawful basis and retention period for ID images, how are cross-border transfers to US cloud hosts handled, and can the founder be DPO? Are the non-circumvention and idea-confidentiality clauses enforceable, does the Consumer Act apply to foreign business buyers, and how far can moral rights be waived? What is the employment-misclassification exposure, and what is the current status of the freelance bill? What is the exact ITA fine schedule and the Online Business Database registration process?

5. Marketing: spend nothing for 60 days, then buy Philippine impressions at P75–P120 per thousand

Positioning

For creators: **"Proven video ideas, researched by verified Philippine researchers, paid per idea. See the proof before you pay, and never pay a subscription."** The product's defensible claim, carried over from the feature research, is that no outlier tool can show an idea worked *for the creator who bought it*; a marketplace with the results loop can, which turns "trust me, it's a 12x outlier" into "creators who used this researcher's ideas got 2.4x their usual views". Against tools, CRENT sells human filtering, recreatability and beginner-level instructions; against Fiverr, it sells proof-before-payment and a 72-hour dispute window; against hiring, it sells per-batch buying with no payroll. For researchers: **"Kumita per proven idea, walang bidding, walang fees, GCash payout."** The Philippine audience is saturated with job scams built on "tasks" paid P40–P100 via GCash, Telegram groups and fake earnings screenshots ([In teraksyon/PhilStar](#); [PinoyRemote](#), [VA scam red flags](#)), so legitimacy is the hook: a registered company name, a named

founder with a face, "no fees, no tasks, no money handling", earnings expressed in pesos per sold idea with a worked example, and a stated payout timeline.

Launch sequence

Every marketplace Lenny Rachitsky studied but one constrained itself by geography or category at the start, supply was the biggest lever, and roughly a third subsidised quality early ([Lenny, kickstart and scale a marketplace](#), search excerpt, page blocked). So: **Weeks 0–2**, run the name checks in Section 6, register the business, and set up the pages. **Weeks 1–4, supply first**: recruit 50 verified researchers in one or two niches (say personal finance and fitness) through free OnlineJobs.ph postings, which pre-vet profiles ([Connectively](#)), value-first posts in the 200K-member groups, and a founder-run "CRENT Researchers PH" Facebook group; fund the first 5–10 briefs yourself as "house demand" so every new researcher sells within 7 days. **Weeks 4–8, founding creators**: a waitlist with a double-sided referral (both sides get a free unlock), founder posts in r/NewTubers and r/PartneredYoutube answering "how do I find ideas" with disclosed affiliation, LinkedIn posts aimed at agency owners, and 3–5 creator educators with 10K–100K followers paid in credits plus 25%-of-fee affiliate commission. **Weeks 8–12, Product Hunt**, only once ~100 researchers and ~200 ideas are live, because in 2026 Product Hunt rewards comments, maker replies and products that bring new users, and only "Featured" products get meaningful traffic; a launch is a 4–6-week project ([Forkoff PH playbook](#); [Analog](#)). Paid sponsorship is out of reach: Colin and Samir's floor is \$5,000 and newsletter CPMs run \$20–\$80 ([Creator Science podcast #263](#); [InfluencerFee](#)).

Channels by side

Supply: "Online Filipino Freelancers" (227,680+ members), "Filipino Freelancer Online Home Based Job" (202.5K), "Startup PH: Jobs" (52.6K) ([Medium](#), [Facebook groups for Filipino freelancers](#)), FLIP 2.0, OnlineJobs.ph, and the founder's own group. Group posts reach 40–50% of members versus about 1.3% of followers for a Page post ([SocialRais](#); [MeetEdgar](#)), which is why the owned group matters more than the Page. Most large groups ban raw job ads, so ask admins first and post "how I find viral formats" tutorials with CRENT in the comments. Demand: r/NewTubers, r/PartneredYoutube, r/CreatorsAdvice (58% of founder-relevant subreddits ban self-promotion outright or gate it, so participate first and link only when asked or in your profile ([Redship](#))), LinkedIn for agencies and personal brands, Skool communities for coaches, Facebook SMM groups, tool-vendor comment sections and SEO around "1of10 alternative" and "outlier", and micro-creator affiliates.

Content plan and cadence

On Instagram in 2025 carousels led engagement at 0.55% and earned the most saves while Reels delivered about 36% more reach and 45% more comments ([Socialinsider 2025 benchmarks PDF](#); [Carouselli](#)). Instagram capped hashtags at **5 per post in December 2025** and suppresses posts that exceed it ([Social Media Examiner](#)); Reels over 3 minutes are not recommended to new audiences and 30–90 seconds is the sweet spot ([Disrupt Marketing](#)). Buffer's analysis of 9.6M posts supports **3–5 feed posts a week plus 1–2 Stories a day**, with consistent posters earning 450% more engagement per post ([Buffer](#)). Run two accounts (one per side) or one account with a clear content split: Monday carousel (proof or earnings), Wednesday Reel (demo or testimonial), Friday carousel (education: filter, hooks, how money flows), Saturday static (offer or announcement), Stories daily. Post the Philippine content at **8–10 PM PHT** (Wednesday and Friday strongest), which also catches early-rising US creators, and schedule US buyer posts **Tuesday–Thursday 9–11 AM ET (9–11 PM PHT)** ([SEOSpecialist.com.ph](#); [CreatorFlow best times](#)). Keep the first line of every caption under 125 characters so it survives truncation ([Hootsuite](#)).

Twelve ready-to-post concepts

Square brackets mark numbers you must replace with real data from the app; do not publish a bracketed figure or an invented testimonial.

Creator side (US/UK/AU buyers)

C1 — "Spent your weekend looking for one video idea?" Carousel, 5 slides, 1080×1350. Slide 1: large text on a dark card, a tired creator scrolling at 2 AM (stock or illustrated). Slide 2: "What a proven idea looks like" with a mock

pitch card: proof visible (platform, source views, source followers, outlier badge), idea blurred. Slide 3: "What you get when you unlock it": hook, format, edit steps, audio, CTA, caption. Slide 4: "Pay per idea. No subscription." with \$5 / \$8 / \$12 tiles. Slide 5: CTA button "Post your first brief, 2 unlocks free". Caption: Spent your weekend looking for one video idea? Verified researchers in the Philippines find videos that got 500K+ views from accounts under 100K followers, then write you the hook, the shot list and the audio steps so you can film it tomorrow. You see the proof before you pay, and you pay per idea, not per month. Founding creators get 2 free unlocks. Link in bio. #shortformvideo #contentcreator #videoideas #youtubeshorts #creatoreconomy

C2 — "This card is locked for a reason." Static, 1080×1080. A single pitch card, large, with the proof row crisp and the idea row blurred; a small padlock; one line of micro-copy "Unlock reveals the hook, breakdown and source". Caption: Ideas aren't protected by copyright. That's why researchers won't show you theirs on Fiverr until you've paid, and why you can't check the proof. On CRENT the proof is public and the idea is locked. Source views, source followers, format and platform are on the card. The hook, the breakdown and the source link appear when you unlock, and your money goes to the researcher only then. 72 hours to dispute if it isn't as described. #contentstrategy #videoideas #tiktokcreator #instagramreels #creatortools

C3 — "A tool gives you a link. A researcher gives you a plan." Carousel, 4 slides. Slide 1: split screen, left "Outlier tool" showing a bare thumbnail and view count, right "CRENT brief" showing a full brief. Slide 2: the brief template as a checklist (thought process, format, 3-second hook, edit steps in seconds, audio, notes, CTA, caption). Slide 3: "Written for beginners. No studio, no editor." Slide 4: price comparison tiles "\$29–\$69/month for a tool" vs "\$8 for one idea a human already verified". Caption: 1of10, vidIQ and Viewstats are great at finding videos that outperformed. They can't tell you whether the idea or the creator's face did the work, whether the format is saturated, or how to recreate it with a phone and CapCut. A CRENT brief does all three, in plain English. One Sandcastles month buys you five ideas a human already verified. #youtubegrowth #contentcreator #videoideas #creatoreconomy #shortformvideo

C4 — "Idea → video → views." Carousel, 3 slides (publish only with a real, consented example). Slide 1: the unlocked pitch card. Slide 2: screenshot of the creator's posted video. Slide 3: a simple two-bar chart "Channel median [X] views" vs "This video [Y] views", with the researcher's handle credited. Caption: [Creator] unlocked this idea for \$[price] on [date], filmed it in an afternoon and posted it on [date]. It did [Y] views against a channel median of [X]. The researcher, [handle], sees that result on their profile, which is why CRENT researchers care what happens after you buy. Format inspired by @[original creator]; execution original. #creatorresults #videoideas #shortformvideo #tiktokgrowth #youtubeshorts

C5 — "For agencies: researchers trained to the standard you already use." Static, 1080×1350, LinkedIn-friendly. A tracking-sheet screenshot (columns: handle, platform, followers, views, post date, hook, format, verdict) with a headline overlay. Caption: If you run short-form for coaches or personal brands, you already know the unit of work: a batch of five recreatable ideas, each with raw numbers, a hook, edit steps and a CTA. CRENT researchers pitch in exactly that format, you pay per batch instead of per hire, and every pitch shows source views and followers before you unlock. No recruiting, no payroll, no VPN to provision. Post a brief with your client's niche and see pitches within 48 hours. #socialmediaagency #shortformcontent #contentmarketing #agencylife #creatoreconomy

C6 — "Founding creator offer." Static, 1080×1080. Bold offer card: "2 free unlocks when you fund your first brief. Give 1, get 1 when a friend funds theirs." Caption: We're opening CRENT to 100 founding creators. Fund your first brief (from \$20) and get 2 unlocks on us. Refer a creator and you both get another one when they fund theirs. Verified Philippine researchers, proof before payment, 72-hour dispute window, no subscription. Link in bio. #contentcreator #videoideas #creatoreconomy #shortformvideo #youtubeshorts

Researcher side (Philippines)

R1 — "Kumita per proven idea. Walang bidding." Reel cover / static, 1080×1920 and 1080×1350. Founder's face or a real researcher at a desk, phone in hand, with the headline and a small "Registered: [DTI/SEC name and number]" footer. Caption: Marunong ka bang maghanap ng viral na Reels at TikToks? Sa CRENT, creators mula US at UK ang nagpo-post ng briefs, ikaw ang magpi-pitch ng proven ideas, at babayaran ka per idea na na-unlock. No bidding, no Connects, no fees to join. Payout sa GCash, Maya o bank after a 72-hour hold. Apply with a valid ID and sample research. Link in bio. #freelancingph #onlinejobsph #workfromhomeph #contentresearcher #pinoyfreelancer

R2 — "Legit ba 'to? 5 things we will never ask you." Carousel, 6 slides. Slide 1: headline. Slides 2–6: one line each with a red X icon: "No registration fee", "No 'tasks' paid per click", "No Telegram group", "No using your GCash to receive other people's money", "No earnings screenshots as proof — proof is a payout you can check on your own dashboard". Last slide: company name, registration number, founder's name and photo, support email. Caption: Marami nang scam na "work from home". Kaya ito ang pangako namin: wala kaming hihingin na bayad, walang "tasks", walang Telegram, at hindi namin gagamitin ang GCash mo para tumanggap ng pera ng iba. Ang CRENT ay rehistradong kumpanya sa [DTI/SEC], at ang founder ay si [name] mula Naga City. Kung may tanong, message us dito or email [address]. #freelancingph #onlinejobsph #workfromhomeph #scamalert #pinoyfreelancer

R3 — "Magkano ba talaga?" Carousel, 4 slides. Slide 1: headline. Slide 2: worked example "40 ideas unlocked × \$8 = \$320; minus 10% fee = \$288 ≈ ₱16,700". Slide 3: "That's part-time. Full-time agency researchers earn \$800–\$1,100/month" with the OnlineJobs.ph reference. Slide 4: "Mas mataas ang kita kapag mas mataas ang unlock rate: pitch only ideas that pass the filter." Caption: Simple lang ang math. Kapag 40 ideas mo ang na-unlock sa isang buwan at \$8 bawat isa, \$320 'yan, minus 10% fee, \$288 o mga ₱16,700 (depende sa rate). Hindi 'yan guaranteed; ang kinikita mo ay depende sa kung ilan ang pinili ng creators. Pero walang hourly rate na nagde-dictate, at ang magagaling na researcher sa agencies ngayon ay kumikita ng \$800–\$1,100 a month full-time. #freelancingph #onlinejobsph #contentresearcher #workfromhomeph #pinoyfreelancer

R4 — "Ano ang 'proven idea'?" Carousel, 5 slides. Slides: "Under 100K followers on the source account", "500K+ views", "Posted within the last year (under 3 months is best)", "Viral in the US or Europe", "Recreatable with a phone". Final slide: "Fail one, don't pitch it." Caption: Hindi lahat ng viral ay pwedeng i-pitch. Ang hinahanap ng creators ay videos na sumikat dahil sa idea, hindi dahil sikat ang gumawa. Kaya ang filter: source account under 100K followers, 500K+ views, posted within the year, viral sa US o Europe, at kayang gayahin gamit ang phone. Ilagay ang raw numbers sa card ("earned 1.2M views from an account with 40K followers"), hindi "30x". Pass all five, then pitch. #contentresearcher #freelancingph #viralvideo #shortformvideo #onlinejobsph

R5 — "Paano dumating ang pera?" Reel, 20–30 s, screen recording; also a 4-slide carousel. Flow: creator funds brief → you pitch → creator unlocks → 72-hour hold → "Available to withdraw" → GCash. Caption: Ganito ang daloy ng pera sa CRENT. Binabayaran muna ng creator ang budget bago pa niya makita ang pitches mo, at hawak ito ng aming payment partner. Kapag in-unlock ang idea mo, pumapasok ang kita sa "Pending" for 72 hours (dispute window), tapos "Available". Withdraw sa GCash, Maya o bank kapag umabot ng \$20 (~₱1,160), o sumama sa free monthly batch payout. #freelancingph #gcash #onlinejobsph #workfromhomeph #contentresearcher

R6 — "Mag-refer ng kaibigan, kumita ng ₱1,000." Static, 1080×1080. Two-step ladder graphic: "₱300 when your referral's 10th idea is unlocked" and "₱700 at the 50th". Caption: May kakilala kang magaling maghanap ng viral content? I-refer sila. Kapag na-unlock ang ika-10 idea nila, ₱300 sa'yo; sa ika-50, ₱700 pa. Hindi kami nagbabayad para sa sign-up lang, kaya walang fake accounts, at ang top ambassadors bawat buwan ay may bonus. Referral link sa dashboard mo. #freelancingph #onlinejobsph #referral #workfromhomeph #pinoyfreelancer

Video briefs

Ads that win the first three seconds see 62% higher completion and 54% lower CPM; viewers decide in 1.5–3 seconds; native, creator-style footage beats polished commercials; never open with a logo ([MBADV, 3-second hook rule](#); [Creatify](#)). All scripts are 9:16, captions burned in, one CTA.

60-second explainer (creators). 0–3 s, on-screen text over a creator scrolling at night: "Spent all weekend looking for one video idea?" VO: "If you've ever lost a weekend to the For You page looking for your next idea, this is for you." 3–15 s, screen recording of the brief feed and a grid of locked pitch cards. VO: "CRENT is a marketplace where you post a short brief, fund it, and verified researchers in the Philippines pitch you ideas that already worked. Each card shows the proof: the platform, how many views the source got, how small the account was." 15–30 s, a card unlocks, the brief scrolls. VO: "Unlock the ones you like. You get the hook, the format, the edit steps with timings, the audio, the CTA and a caption, written for someone filming on a phone." 30–45 s, three proof tiles. VO: "Every researcher is ID-verified and rated by results, not stars. You pay per idea, five to fifteen dollars, no subscription. And you have 72 hours to dispute anything that isn't as described." 45–55 s, before/after: card → posted video → view count (real example only). VO: "Creators log what happened after they posted, so researchers are judged on your views, not their promises." 55–60 s,

end card. VO: "Post your first brief at [domain]. Two unlocks are free." Cut a 30-second version from beats 1, 2, 3 and 6 for Reels.

15-second locked-card demo. No voice; captions and a trending low-volume track. 0–2 s: cursor hovers a blurred card; the hook title and "1.4M views from a 38K-follower account" are legible. Text: "Proof shows. Idea hidden." 2–8 s: tap Unlock, confirmation "\$8 from your budget", the brief expands (hook, shot list, audio). Text: "Unlock = pay the researcher." 8–13 s: zoom on "Edit steps: 0–3 s hook ... 3–12 s ...". Text: "Written for a phone and CapCut." 13–15 s: end card "Pay per idea. [domain]".

Researcher testimonial (template; record with a real, consenting researcher, Taglish, phone camera, 30–40 s). 0–3 s, to camera: "Kumita ako ng ₱[amount] this month sa CRENT, walang bidding." 3–12 s, screen of the dashboard with amounts visible or blurred: "Ganito 'yan. May brief ang creator, halimbawa fitness Shorts. Hinahanap ko 'yung videos na 500K+ views pero maliit lang ang account, tapos sinusulat ko 'yung hook at steps." 12–24 s, show a pitch card and the "Unlocked" state: "Kapag in-unlock ng creator, pasok ang bayad. 72 hours hold, tapos withdraw sa GCash." 24–32 s, to camera: "Walang fee para sumali, walang tasks, walang Telegram. Rehistradong kumpanya. Ang kailangan lang, valid ID at sample research." 32–36 s: "Apply sa [domain]. Sabihin mong galing kay [name]." Disclose any referral payment on-screen.

UGC-style ad scripts. *UGC-1, creator, 20 s:* "I used to spend six hours a week looking for ideas. [hold up phone] Now I post a brief on Sunday night, and by Tuesday I've got twelve pitches. See this? 900K views from an account with 20K followers. I paid eight dollars to see how they did it, filmed it Wednesday. [cut to the posted video's view count] I'm not saying every idea hits. I'm saying I stopped scrolling. Link's in the caption, first two unlocks are free." *UGC-2, agency owner, 25 s:* "If you run short-form for clients, you know the pain of hiring researchers. I tried CRENT for one client last month: one brief, five-idea batch, forty bucks. The pitches came in the same format my team uses, hook, edit steps, audio, CTA, and every card showed source views before I paid. I kept three, passed on two with a reason, and the budget for those two came back. It's not replacing my team. It's the bench." *UGC-3, researcher, Taglish, 20 s:* "Tanong ng kapatid ko: scam ba 'yang CRENT? [laughs] Eto ang sagot. [screen: dashboard] Walang binayaran ako para sumali. Nag-apply ako with ID, na-approve after two days, nag-pitch ng limang ideas sa isang fitness brief, dalawa ang na-unlock, \$16. After 72 hours, available. Withdraw sa GCash. Hindi 'yan yaman, pero totoo. Link sa bio."

Graphic design asset list

Sizes below are the standard platform specs; confirm against each platform's current help page before export.

ASSET	SIZE	NOTES
Logo: primary, mono, icon; favicon	SVG + 512×512 PNG; 32×32 / 180×180	Qualified wordmark for app stores (see Section 6)
Instagram/Facebook feed carousel templates (proof, earnings, education, offer)	1080×1350 (4:5)	Dark and light variants; 5-slide master
Square static templates	1080×1080	Offer cards, announcements
Reels / Stories / TikTok cover and end cards	1080×1920 (9:16)	Safe zone: keep text out of the top 250 px and bottom 400 px
Locked pitch-card mock (blurred idea, crisp proof)	1080×1350 and 1080×1920	The single most reused asset
Brief-template checklist graphic	1080×1350	For C3, R4
Facebook Page cover	820×312 (upload 1640×624)	Both sides, with registration footer on the PH page
Facebook Group cover	1640×856	"CRENT Researchers PH"
LinkedIn company banner	1128×191	Agency positioning
YouTube channel banner	2560×1440 (safe area 1546×423)	

ASSET	SIZE	NOTES
Open Graph / link preview image	1200×630	Homepage, /how-it-works, /cres
Product Hunt gallery images and thumbnail	1270×760; 240×240	Locked-card demo GIF as first gallery item
Video thumbnails for explainer and testimonials	1280×720	
Email header and footer	600 px wide	Transactional (Resend) and digest
Anti-scam "legitimacy block" (company name, registration no., founder photo, support email)	1080×1080 and 1080×1920	Reused in every PH post
One-page agency PDF (brief → pitch → unlock → results, with sample tracking sheet)	A4 / US Letter	For LinkedIn DMs

Budget plans and expected results

Philippine Meta impressions are among the cheapest in the world: **all-industry CPM averaged about \$1.39 from July 2025 to July 2026**, roughly ₱75–₱120 per thousand, with 2–5x spikes around 11.11, 12.12 and Christmas ([SuperAds P H CPM, page blocked, search excerpt](#); [Spiralytics](#)). US traffic costs more: Gupta Media tracked Meta at \$6.59–\$8.16 CPM and \$0.68–\$0.69 per link click in 2025, and WordStream's closest proxies are Career & Employment at \$0.73 CPC / \$17.64 CPL and Arts & Entertainment at \$0.88 CPC / \$18.17 CPL ([Gupta Media](#); [WordStream 2025](#)). Waitlist pages convert about 11% of visitors at the median and 20–40% with referral mechanics ([Waitlister, page blocked, search excerpt](#)); no-card trials convert to paid at 4–6% conservatively ([Flint](#)). A Filipino short-form editor costs \$20–\$100 per video or ₱20,000–₱30,000 a month full-time ([Vidpros](#); [JobStreet](#)). The expectations below are **estimates derived from those benchmarks with generic CTR assumptions**, not guarantees.

PLAN	WHERE THE MONEY GOES	EXPECTED MONTH-1 RESULT (EST.)
₱0/month	Founder time only: 3–5 PH freelancer groups (with admin permission), OnlineJobs.ph free posts, own FB group, Reddit, LinkedIn, 3–4 posts/week per side, Product Hunt later	30–80 researcher applications; 50–150 buyer waitlist signups from ~500–1,500 landing visits at ~11%; heavily dependent on group admins
₱10,000/month (~\$170)	₱6K PH recruitment ads (~50–80K impressions → 350–800 clicks at 0.5–1% CTR → 40–100 applications at 10–15%); ₱4K to one micro-creator affiliate seed (free credits + 25%-of-fee commission) rather than US CPC, which would buy only ~75–100 clicks and ~8–11 signups	40–100 applications; 1 affiliate creator producing a steady trickle of founding buyers
₱50,000/month (~\$860)	₱20–25K part-time PH editor (8–12 videos/month); ₱10K PH recruitment ads (80–200 applications); ₱10–15K US ads (~200–350 clicks → 20–40 signups at 11%, or 9–14 leads at ~\$18 CPL); remainder to 2–3 affiliate seeds	80–200 applications; 20–40 buyer signups; at 5–10% paid conversion, 2–6 paying buyers a month from paid alone, so organic and affiliates must carry the rest

The implication is that paid spend buys supply cheaply and demand expensively; put pesos into Philippine recruitment and video production, and win creators with content, Reddit, LinkedIn and affiliates.

KPIs

Track liquidity before anything else, because a marketplace where a brief gets no pitches has a supply problem, not a UX problem ([MarketplaceStudio](#); [Lowcode.agency](#)). Supply: applications → approved → first idea listed within 7 days; ideas per active researcher per week; pitch approval rate. Demand: waitlist signups, free-unlock redemption, first paid unlock, repeat-unlock rate, average budget top-up. Liquidity: **fill rate = share of briefs receiving 3+ pitches within 48 hours (target 80%)**, time to first pitch, share of listed ideas unlocked within 14 days. Economics: CAC per side, blended take, refund and dispute rate, contribution per transaction. Results loop: share of unlocked ideas with a logged result,

median result multiple. Free tooling covers all of it: Meta Business Suite, PostHog, Google Search Console and UTM links per channel.

6. "CRENT" carries a HIGH trademark risk in the US; verify before you rename

Nothing about the name could be verified from a primary registrar or register page, because every WHOIS, RDAP, registrar, trademark and social endpoint was blocked. What the search index shows is unfavourable. **crent.com is held by Crent Inc.**, the Los Angeles credit-building fintech (founded 2015, seed round \$750,000 in 2017, 2–10 employees), which also appears to hold Instagram @crent and facebook.com/crent ([Crunchbase](#); [LinkedIn](#), [Crent Inc.](#)); whether the company is still operating in 2026 is unknown. Its **US word mark CRENT (Reg. 5,686,508)** covers credit services and "providing a website featuring technology that enables users to make rent payments, pay bills, make payments, split payments with others" ([Justia](#)); the Section 8 continued-use declaration fell due between February 2024 and August 2025, and whether it was filed could not be checked on TSDR. An app named "Crent" by Applirent Oy (Finnish equipment-rental software) already sits on **both app stores** ([App Store id1491327816](#); [Google Play com.crent.asmob](#)), C-Rent is a German car-rental software company at crent.de ([crent.de](#)), Krent is a Nigerian rental app, and a Canadian entertainer with 1.2M TikTok followers brands as "THE CRENT" at @officialcrent ([TikTok](#)), which will dominate social search for the word. GitHub user "crent" exists ([GitHub](#)), and the team's own public repo already exposes the codename. The linguistic check is clean (no meaning in Filipino, Spanish, Dutch or German, no offensive reading), but the dominant parse online is "C + rent", a crowded cluster of rental brands that fights the "Content Research Expert" origin and weakens distinctiveness. The clean signals are only that no Philippine company named Crent surfaced (only the unrelated CRENSERV Industrial Corp.) and that crent.io, .co, .app, .ph and the get/try/hq variants have no indexed web presence, which is consistent with, but not proof of, being free.

The risk is concentrated where the customers are. IPOPHL examines against Philippine and Madrid marks, not US ones, so a Philippine filing might succeed; but CRENT's buyers are US creators, its app would be distributed in US app stores, and it processes payments, which is the service the US registration recites. A cease-and-desist from a small fintech is survivable; a rebrand after launch, with handles, domains, a trademark filing and twelve posts of content invested, is expensive. The alternatives fare as follows from what could be seen: **PitchFile and Crentive showed no competing brand at all**; Outlier Desk, the current name, has no namesake but sits beside Outlier Kit, a YouTube-research tool in the same function ([Crozdesk](#), [Outlier Kit](#)); Crenta is used by a Kenyan agency and a GitHub user; HookDesk is a live Chrome extension ([Chrome Web Store](#)); IdeaScout has at least three live software users and is the worst option. "Crent Desk" inherits the CRENT conflict.

The decision rule: spend one morning on verification before anything else. Open https://tsdr.uspto.gov/#caseNumber=86873602&caseType=SERIAL_NO&searchType=statusSearch and read whether Reg. 5,686,508 is live or cancelled; run IPOPHL eSearch at <https://onlineservices.ipophil.gov.ph> and WIPO's <https://branddb.wipo.int> for CRENT, KRENT and CRENTA in Classes 9, 35 and 42; check <https://whois.dot.ph/?search=crent.ph> and <https://www.namecheap.com/domains/registration/results/?domain=crent> for crent.ph, crent.com.ph and getcrent.com; open [instagram.com/crent](https://www.instagram.com/crent), [tiktok.com/@crent](https://www.tiktok.com/@crent), [x.com/crent](https://www.x.com/crent), [youtube.com/@crent](https://www.youtube.com/@crent) and [linkedin.com/company/crent](https://www.linkedin.com/company/crent) in a browser; search DTI BNRS at <https://bnrs.dti.gov.ph/search>. If the US mark is dead and IPOPHL is clear, CRENT is usable with mitigations: register crent.ph plus a .com variant (~\$60 a year), use a qualified app-store title such as "Crent: Content Research", accept handles like @crentph or @getcrent, file in the Philippines in Classes 35 and 42, and do not file in the US. If the US mark is live, keep "Outlier Desk" (which is already the product-branded name in the repo, has no namesake and is a distinct two-word mark) or run the same checks on PitchFile and Crentive and pick the one that clears. Either way, no name should go onto a DTI or SEC form until these checks are done, because name approval there confers no trademark rights ([FilipiKnow](#)).

Do this next: the first 30 days

Week 1: run the name verification above and decide the brand; buy the domains; book a consultation with a Philippine lawyer or CPA and send them the "questions for a lawyer" list, leading with the OPS question and the withholding regime. Week 2: file the OPC on eSPARC (or the DTI name if you accept the liability), start the Naga City permit, book the BIR registration, and email Xendit and PayMongo sales with the seven written questions in the before-launch checklist; create the Supabase Pro project in Singapore, the Vercel Pro project, the Resend domain and the Better Stack monitors. Week 3: write the terms, privacy notice, refund policy and the auto-generated per-engagement contract; design the locked-card mock, the legitimacy block and the carousel master; open the "CRENT Researchers PH" Facebook group and post the first OnlineJobs.ph listing; ask admins of three large freelancer groups for permission to post a tutorial. Week 4: approve the first 20–50 researchers in two niches, fund 5–10 house briefs, record the 15-second demo and the explainer, and open the founding-creator waitlist with the give-1-get-1 referral; start the Reddit and LinkedIn cadence. Keep Product Hunt for the week you cross 100 researchers and 200 live ideas, and file the trademark in the week the name clears.

Conclusion

The product's hardest problems are not technical. The stack is cheap and boring, the fee structure is already in the defensible range, and the buyers are identifiable down to the job ads they post. What decides whether CRENT survives its first year is three non-engineering choices: that creator money never sits in CRENT's own account, that researchers are verified to the Internet Transactions Act standard from the first signup, and that the brand does not walk into a word-for-word US trademark on a payments website. The second of these is also the marketing: a published filter, raw numbers on every card, a registered company name and a founder's face are what turn "is this legit?" into a recruiting advantage in a market where most "GCash earning" offers are scams.

The deeper implication is that CRENT's moat is the results loop, not the price. Fiverr sells unverified ideas at twenty cents each and tools sell links for \$29 a month; neither can say what happened after the creator filmed. A marketplace that logs the posted video's views against the channel median, shows that number on the researcher's profile and pays faster to the researchers whose ideas work has a reason to exist that a 10% fee alone does not give it. Build the launch around proving that loop with twenty real examples, and the name, the take rate and the ad budget become secondary.

Appendix A. Design assets (ready to post)

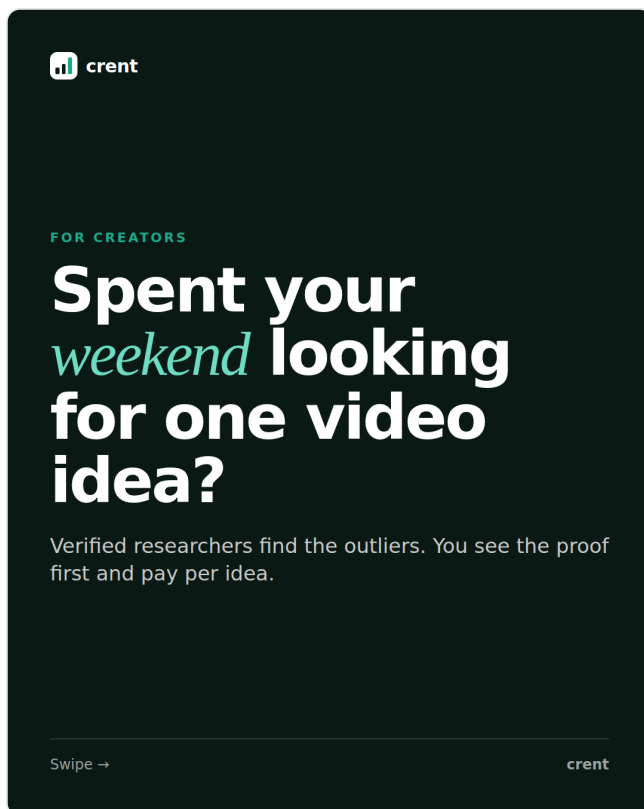
All files are in `docs/marketing/assets/` at full resolution. Bracketed text (e.g. [DTI/SEC no.], [X] views) must be replaced with real figures before publishing; never publish an invented testimonial or result. The visual system: off-white and near-black, one teal accent (#0f7a68), monospace numerals for proof, an italic serif for the one emphasised word, and the three-bar mark where the tallest, teal bar is the outlier.

Editable Canva designs

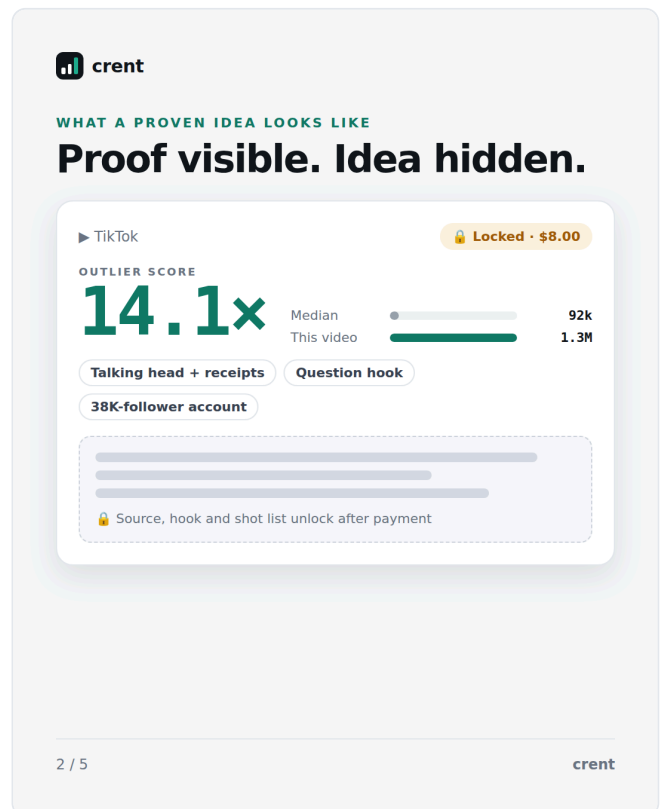
Three designs were also generated in your Canva account and can be edited there (Canva's AI generation quota ran out after these; the rest of the set was produced directly in the house style):

- Instagram post, creator launch (“Stop guessing what to post”): canva.link/yks42lah23nccyl
- Facebook post, researcher recruiting (“Magaling ka bang maghanap ng viral videos?”): canva.link/o00a95qc5hep9gp
- Instagram carousel, “How CRENT works” (5 pages): canva.link/6i2m2dgrah0kg2j

Creator side



C1 · carousel cover



C1 · slide 2

WHAT YOU GET WHEN YOU UNLOCK

A plan, not a link.

TikTok
Unlocked

OUTLIER SCORE
14.1x

Median
This video

92k
1.3M

Talking head + receipts
Question hook

38K-follower account

HOOK
"I tracked every peso I spent for thirty days"

+ source link · why it worked · shot list with timings · CTA

3 / 5
crent

C1 · slide 3

PAY PER IDEA

No subscription. No retainer.

\$5
typical floor

\$8
most briefs

\$12
deep briefs

Fund a brief from \$20. Unused budget is refunded when it closes. 72 hours to dispute anything not as described.

4 / 5
crent

C1 · slide 4

Post your first brief.

2 unlocks free.

Founding creators only. Verified Philippine researchers, proof before payment, pay per idea.

Link in bio →

5 / 5
crent

C1 · slide 5

This card is locked for a *reason*.

TikTok
Locked · \$8.00

OUTLIER SCORE
14.1x

Median
This video

92k
1.3M

Talking head + receipts
Question hook

38K-follower account

Source, hook and shot list unlock after payment

Unlock reveals the hook, breakdown and source

C2 · locked card
crent

C2 · locked card

A tool gives you a link. A researcher gives you a *plan*.

OUTLIER TOOL

thumbnail

1.3M views
...and that's it

CRENT BRIEF

- ✓ Why it worked
- ✓ 3-second hook, exact words
- ✓ Edit steps in seconds
- ✓ Audio for TT + IG
- ✓ CTA + caption

\$29–69
per month for a tool

\$8
one idea a human verified

Written for a phone and CapCut

crent

C3 · tool vs researcher

IDEA → VIDEO → VIEWS

Channel median [X]. This video [Y].

Channel median

[X]

This video

[Y]

Researcher @[handle] · unlocked for \$[price] on [date] · format inspired by @[original], execution original

Template: publish only with a real, consented example. Replace every bracket.

Results logged by the creator in the app

crent

C4 · result template (fill brackets)

FOR AGENCIES

Researchers trained to the standard you *already use*.

Handle	Followers	Views	Hook	Verdict
@mealpremia	38K	1.4M	"I spent \$11 on dinner for 5"	Pitch
@coachdan	72K	910K	"Stop doing cardio first"	Pitch
@bigbrand	2.1M	3.0M	"Our new drop"	Reject: famous
@fitjo	19K	620K	"POV: day 1 vs day 90"	Pitch

Five-idea batches. Source views and followers on every card before you unlock. Pay per batch, not per hire.

Pitches within 48 hours

crent

C5 · agencies

FOUNDING CREATOR OFFER · 100 SPOTS

2 free unlocks when you fund your first brief.

Give 1, get 1 when a friend funds theirs. From \$20. No subscription.

crent · link in bio

crent

C6 · founding offer

Researcher side (Philippines)



PARA SA PINOY FREELANCERS

Kumita per *proven idea.*

Walang bidding.

Creators mula US at UK ang nagpo-post ng briefs. Ikaw ang nagpi-pitch. Bayad per idea na na-unlock, payout sa GCash, Maya o bank.

ID-verified only

No fees to join

Keep 90% of every unlock

Registered: [DTI/SEC name and no.]

crent

R1 · Kumita per proven idea



Freelance content researcher?

Your finds are worth money.

 Pitch proven video ideas to creators abroad

 Paid in USD, withdrawn to GCash or Maya

 You keep 90% of every unlock

Apply · link ↑

R1 · Story 9:16



LEGIT BA 'TO?

5 things we will *never* ask you.

- ✗ Registration fee
- ✗ "Tasks" paid per click
- ✗ A Telegram group
- ✗ Your GCash to receive other people's money
- ✗ Earnings screenshots as proof

Proof = a payout you can check on your own dashboard

crent

R2 · Legit ba 'to?



REHISTRADONG KUMpanya

Who you're dealing with

Company: [Registered name]
Registration: [DTI/SEC no.]
BIR TIN: [TIN]
Founder: [Name], Naga City
Support: [email] · reply within 1 business day

Reuse this block in every Philippine post. Fill the brackets before publishing.

crent

crent

R2 · legitimacy block (fill brackets)



MAGKANO BA TALAGA?

Simple lang ang math.

40 ideas unlocked × \$8	\$320
Researcher fee 10%	-\$32
Sa'yo	\$288 ≈ ₱16,700

Hindi guaranteed: depende sa ilan ang na-unlock. Pero walang hourly rate, at full-time agency researchers ay kumikita ng \$800-\$1,100 a month ngayon.

Rate depends on the day's USD→PHP

crent

R3 · Magkano ba talaga?



ANO ANG "PROVEN IDEA"?

Pass all five, then pitch.

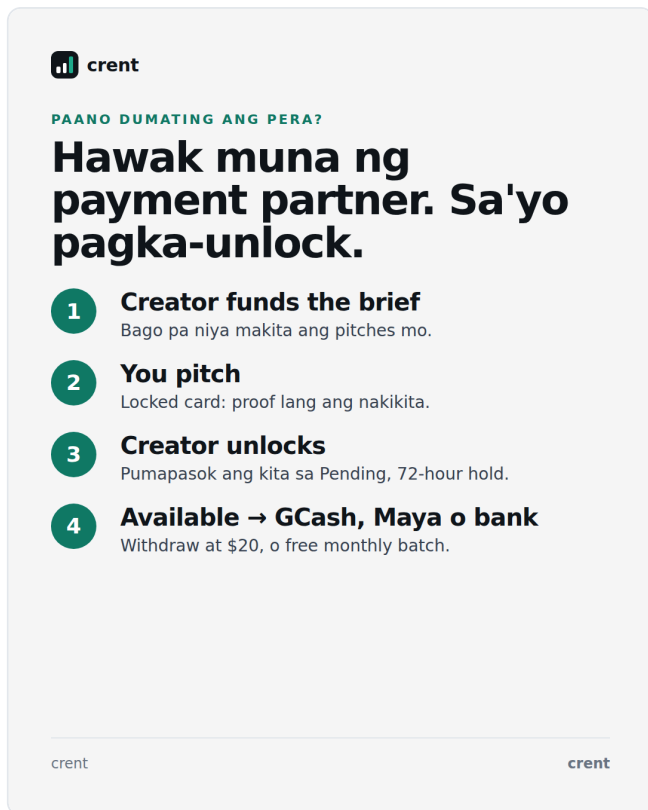
- 1 Source account under 100K followers
- 2 500K+ views
- 3 Posted within the last year (under 3 months is best)
- 4 Viral in the US or Europe
- 5 Recreatable with a phone

Ilagay ang raw numbers sa card: "1.2M views from a 40K-follower account", hindi "30x".

Fail one, don't pitch it

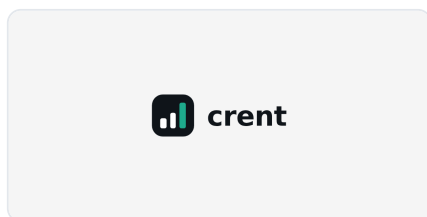
crent

R4 · Ano ang proven idea?

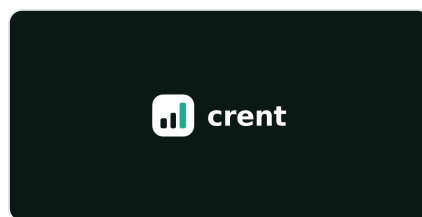


R5 · Paano dumating ang pera?

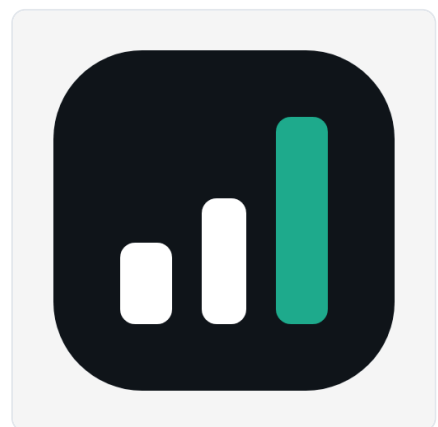
Brand



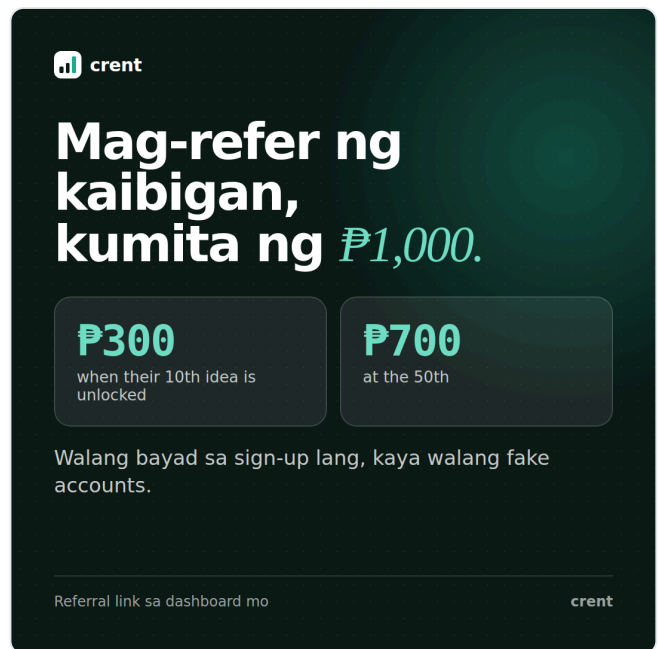
Logo, light



Logo, dark



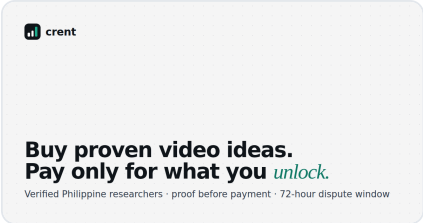
App icon 512



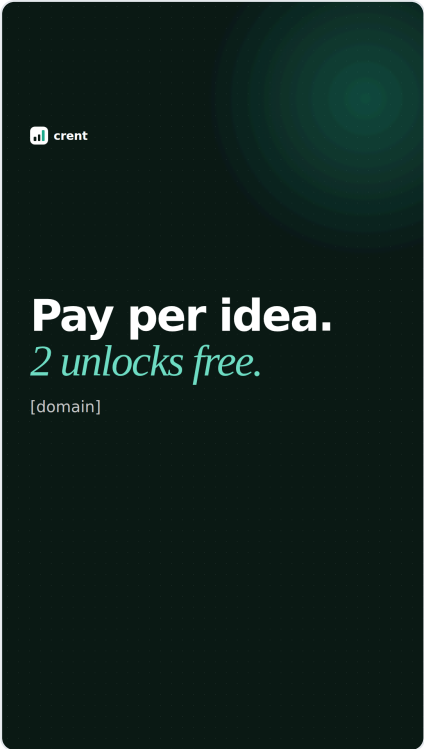
R6 · Referral ladder



Facebook cover 1640×624



Link preview 1200×630



Video end card 9:16